Security in Malligai was beefed up under the supervision of Sri Kumar following the IB's reports of a possible attack on the building. The CRPF's Cobra commandos were stationed there; a fire engine and two armoured Jeeps had also been brought in. Sri Kumar and Verma tried to ease the staff, saying there was nothing to worry about. Additional security meant they had become VIPs. But inside, they were all tense. There could not be a bigger terror than the LTTE in the state. However, news of a possible strike on Malligai was kept only within the key members of the SIT.

The top three of the CBI—Vijay Karan, S.K. Datta and Kaarthikeyan—were headed for the airport to catch a flight to Colombo. Anirudhya had called the SIT office hearing the CBI's second-in-command, Datta, was also in Madras. But he was told that he was not in office. Actually, he had been seeking Datta's time the past few days. A second call to a 'friend' in Malligai revealed that Datta was going to Colombo with two others. Anirudhya's next destination was to catch Datta at the airport. He rushed for it.

Kaarthikeyan was going through the files one more time, sitting in the airport's VIP lounge. They contained photographs of the kurta-pyjama-clad man and a comparative study of the modus operandi of the assassins in both the Rajiv Gandhi and the K. Padmanabha cases pointed to links with the LTTE. Satisfied, Kaarthikeyan told his assistant he could leave. It seemed he had noticed Anirudhya's arrival but chose instead to focus on his files. He certainly didn't want to be pestered with questions in front of his bosses.

Datta, too, was not comfortable talking to a reporter with his boss around. However, the latter made it easy. Vijay Karan got everyone, including Kaarthikeyan, involved in a discussion of the details, which he knew would not hamper the investigation if out in the press. The topic was once again Haribabu's photographs. He didn't want to disappoint a reporter who had come all the way to the airport chasing a story. He was exactly the same in his previous assignment as the Delhi police commissioner. Karan knew how to handle the press without giving out too much.

The SIT had scrutinized the ten photographs again and again. Yet, the depth of the involvement of the photographer with the killers was unclear.